BIOLOGICAL/PHYSICAL FALSE BELIEF #31 · BRAIN INJURY AND MEMORY

"I'm not the person I used to be, so I'm less of a person."

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Where it often comes from

After a stroke, concussion, or other brain injury, abilities, personality, and speed can change. Family may say, "You're not the same," and the loss of who we were can feel like a loss of value.

What Scripture teaches

God's image in us is not tied to speed, memory, or skill: "God created man in His own image" (Genesis 1:27). "Even the very hairs of your head are all numbered" (Luke 12:7). "Though our outer self is wasting away, yet our inner self is being renewed day by day." "Your hands have made me and fashioned me" (Psalm 119:73). God knows you completely and loves you as you are now. Your worth was never your performance. You are still you, and still His.

> *"So God created man in His own image; in the image of God He created him; male and female He created them"* (Genesis 1:27).

Also see

> "And even the very hairs of your head are all numbered. So do not be afraid; you are worth more than many sparrows" (Luke 12:7).

> "Therefore we do not lose heart. Though our outer self is wasting away, yet our inner self is being renewed day by day" (2 Corinthians 4:16).

> "Your hands have made me and fashioned me; give me understanding to learn Your commandments" (Psalm 119:73).

> "Now this is what the LORD says— He who created you, O Jacob, and He who formed you, O Israel: 'Do not fear, for I have redeemed you; I have called you by your name; you are Mine!'" (Isaiah 43:1).

Common self-statements

- I am a shadow of myself.
- I am not me anymore.
- I have lost who I was.
- I am worth less now.
- Others miss the old me.
- I am a disappointment.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I am either who I was or nothing.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that I will never be myself.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling changed and concluding I am less.
- Labeling: Calling myself less of a person.

Challenging questions

- What has changed, and what has stayed the same?
- What do my loved ones still love about me?

- What parts of my character remain, such as kindness, humor, and faith?
- What does Scripture say about the source of my worth?
- What new strengths or insights have developed?
- How can I grieve what has changed and still honor who I am?

Truth summary

> My worth rests in God's image and His love, not in my abilities. I may be changed, but I am not less. I can grieve losses and still live with purpose.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Self-Esteem, Low
- God, Creator
- Suffering
- Sickness
- Grace

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Weak/Tired

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Who Am I — Casting Crowns
Being known and cared for by God rests on His love rather than personal importance.

You Say — Lauren Daigle
God's loving assessment challenges identity based only on weakness or feelings.

Is He Worthy — Andrew Peterson
Honest recognition of a broken world can lead to hope in Christ's final restoration.

Jesus Loves Me — Gaither Vocal Band
This familiar hymn places confidence in Jesus' love rather than personal strength.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I'm not the person I used to be, so I'm less of a person"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I'm not the person I used to be, so I'm less of a person." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What has changed, and what has stayed the same?
- ☐ What do my loved ones still love about me?
- ☐ What parts of my character remain, such as kindness, humor, and faith?
- ☐ What does Scripture say about the source of my worth?
- ☐ What new strengths or insights have developed?
- ☐ How can I grieve what has changed and still honor who I am?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ I am made in God's image.
- ☐ God knows every hair on my head.
- ☐ My inner self is renewed.
- ☐ God made and fashioned me.
- ☐ My worth did not change.
- ☐ I am still me.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Genesis 1:27
  "So God created man in His own image; in the image of God He created him; male and female He created them."
- ☐ Luke 12:7
  "And even the very hairs of your head are all numbered. So do not be afraid; you are worth more than many sparrows."
- ☐ 2 Corinthians 4:16
  "Therefore we do not lose heart. Though our outer self is wasting away, yet our inner self is being renewed day by day."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Still me: Each week, note one thing that is still true of you.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Genesis 1:27 becomes: "Sarah can write: "I am made in God's image, and my worth has not changed.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Self-Esteem, Low" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- [ ] List constants. Write what has not changed.
- [ ] Grieve with a friend. Share what you miss.
- [ ] Ask loved ones. Hear what they treasure about you.
- [ ] Read Genesis 1:27. Remember God's image in you.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I'm not the person I used to be, so I'm less of a person": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Still me
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I'm not the person I used to be, so I'm less of a person.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I have changed and I mourn who I was. Remind me that my worth is in You, and help me live fully as the person You love now. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.